

English–Ewondo Thematic Lexicon

Alternative forms are separated by commas. Forms in brackets are spelling variants. Unclear characters from the original source are retained as ?.

1. Greetings and Introductions

Answer: eyalan, (ngalana)
Farewell, goodbye: o kələg mbəŋ
Friend: mvoe
Friends: bemvoe
Friendship: amvoe
Good evening: mbəmbə ngogé
Good morning: mbəmbə amos, mbəmbə kídí
Good morning [response]: amos mbəmbə
Good night: mbəmbə alú
Greetings: mesugan
Hello, hi: mbolo, (avumaa), masug
Love: edin
Madam, Mrs.: ngal, nga
Mister, Sir: manti, nti
Miss: ngòn
Name: dzoé
Names: moé
Please: bidzuga
See you later: eban
See you soon: bîbála
Thank you: ngan, akiba
Thank you very much: abuí ngan
Welcome: mbəmbə asoán
Yes: owé, (yàà)
No: ai, tege
Not: ki

2. Personal Pronouns

I: mə
You: o
He, she: à
We: bì
You [plural/formal]: mì
They: bə
Me: màá
You: wàá
Him, her: nyé
Us: bíà
You [plural/formal]: mínà
Them: bọ

3. The Verb “To Have”

To have: abələ
I have: mə bələ, məbələ
You have: o bələ, obələ
He/she has: à bələ, àbələ
We have: bì bələ, bîbələ
You have: mì bələ, mîbələ
They have: bə bələ, bəbələ

4. Questions and Answers

Question: nsili
Questions: minsili
Isn't it?: Ngà?
Is/Are/Does...?: Yə?
Who?: Zá?
What?: Dzé?
Which one?: Mfé?
How?: Yá?
How many/how much?: Tan ya?
When?: Oden?
Where?: He?
Where to?: Bia kə he?
Why?: Asú dzé?
Because: Amu
Because of: Etom

So that: asu
Like, as: anə, (mbol)
When: afami, eyon, nyieane
At the time, when: abok
To ask: sili
To answer: yalan

5. Time, Days and Months

Time: abóg
Watch, clock: wás, nkòlòg
Hour: awola
Hours: mewola
Exact time: awola tsab-tsab
Minute: dilig, [dilik]
Minutes: milig, [milik]
Second: akabla
Dawn, sunrise: kíkídígi
Morning: kídí
Noon: zaŋ amos, tólób, (tólóf)
Afternoon: amos
Day: amos
Days: memos
Evening: ngogé, (ngugolé)
Twilight, sunset: məvín mə ngogé
Night: alú
Nights: məlú
Midnight: zaŋ alú, tólób alú
Yesterday: angoge
Today: ána
Tomorrow: okídí
Day before yesterday: ódzan
Day after tomorrow: ódzan
Week: sɔndɔ
Weekend: məmaná mə sɔndɔ
End: məmaná
Holiday, leave: awae
School holidays: awae zikulu
Month: ngon

Year: mbú
Century: esəb, [esəp]
Before, formerly: osusua
After: amvus
Now: etoa bendzi, (etoadzi)
Already: ovon
Soon: etoa dzi
Early: osusua
Sometimes: biyɔŋ bivɔg
Often: mban
Always: kôm esə
Long ago: okoba

Days of the Week

Sunday: sɔndɔ, sabat
Monday: mondi
Tuesday: sɔndɔ mɛlu mɛtan
Wednesday: sɔndɔ mɛlu mɛnyi
Thursday: sɔndɔ mɛlu mɛlə
Friday: sɔndɔ mɛlu mɛbə, freide
Saturday: sɛradə, sɛtadə

Months

January: ngon osu
February: ngon bèè
March: ngon lala
April: ngon nyina
May: ngon tana
June: ngon samena
July: ngon zamgbala
August: ngon mòòmo
September: ngon ebulu
October: ngon awòmo

Celebrations

Celebration, ceremony: abɔg, [abɔk]
Birthday, birth: abyálí, (abiálí)
Easter: Paska

Christmas: Kirîsim?d
Christmas Mass: m?s mə Kirîsim?d
Christmas meal: bidí bí Kirîsim?d
Christmas clothes: biyé bí Kirîsim?d
Christmas gifts: bifá? bí Kirîsim?d
Gifts: bifá?, (atom)

6. Weather and Climate

Weather, climate: abóg
Sky: yób, [yóp]
Heavens: ya yób
Earth: Sí
Moon: ngon
Full moon: abomo
Moonlight: mial, myal
Sun: nlodzobo
Sunset: nlo-dzobo
Star: otitie, (atitie)
Constellation: tolo
Light: mfi?, mfy?
Cloud: nkúd
Clouds: minkúd
Fog, mist: eyono
Wind: evundu, (evunu)
Storm, tornado: nkulu
Lightning: zeyan
Rain: mven
Drizzle: ofobo
Heavy downpour: ekoa
To rain: a noan
Umbrella: otan, nganga
Flood: ndono
Ice: glas
Cold: avəb, ahəb
Cool: aheb, ahəp, aveb, avep
Hot: ndugudu, (ayon)
Hot, boiling, burning: ayon
Drought: esəb

Dry: nkod, [nkot]
To dry up: kód

7. Nature and Landscape

Bush: mefan
Countryside: mvus nnam
Earth, soil: sí
Ploughed land: ndzobo
Root: ndi
Flower: flawa
Raffia: zàm
Tree: elé
Trees: bilé
Forest: afan
Moabi tree: adzab
Baobab: dum
Baobabs: mum
Shea tree: adzab, [adzap]
Charcoal: fidi
Fire: dí, (noan, ndoan)
Flame: nkabag
Mountain, hill: nkol
Lake: etetàg
Pond: nlup
Swamp, marsh: elòbi
Field: afúb, [afúp]
Fields: məfúb
Harvested field: ekodog
Bridge: ekanga
River, stream: (nlod) osoe
Sea: maŋ
Wave: minkumdu
Island: elon
Desert, dry land: nkod-nnam, (nkod nnam)
Stone, pebble: ngok
Stones, pebbles: məkog
Coal: dâg

Petroleum: kalasina

Gas: gaz

Silver: silba

Gold: gold

8. Domestic Animals

Animal: tíð, [tít]

Dog: mvú

Dogs: melu

Cat: esínga

Horse: ekablí, (ekabelí)

Mare: ngál ekablí

Ox: nyàg, [nyàk]

Cow: ngál nyàg

Sheep: ntómbá

Sheep [plural]: mintómbá

Billy goat: kábad, [kábat]

Goat: ngál kábad

Pig: ngoé

Rooster: kúb, [kúp]

Chicken: kúb, [kúp]

Hen: kúb dzia

Duck: elqli

Chicken egg: akikub, [akikup]

9. Wild Animals

Buffalo: nyád, [nyát]

Porcupine: ngom

Rabbit, hare: alapəga

Rat, mouse: edu

Striped rat: sala

Shrew: mbasuma

Tortoise: kúlu

Snail: kóé

Snake: nyọ

Local snake: nsəg

Viper: akpeu, mekpel

Python: mvomo

Chameleon: dzúngo

Toad, frog: bəba

Gorilla: ngi

Chimpanzee: waa

Monkey: ebód, ozəm

Putty-nosed monkey: avəm, (ahəm)

Bat: otan

Lion: əmgbəm

Panther: zə

Camel, dromedary: ózəle

Giraffe: nkqg

Elephant: zôg, [zôk], zoa

Crocodile: ngana

10. Birds

Bird: onon

Little bird: man onon, otonon

Grain-eating bird: odu

Nest: dumba

Nests: mumba

Eagle: ndoe

Hawk: obam

Owl: akun

Magpie: dugu

Magpies: bedugu

Partridge: okpal

Guinea fowl: zum

Parrot: kos

Canary: obee

11. Insects and Small Creatures

Beetle: ndín

Ant: fôm

Red ant: fufui

Driver ant: sulug

Grasshopper, locust: akan

Tsetse fly: elului

Worms: minsɔŋ

Caterpillar: nkoŋ
Caterpillars: minkoŋ
Bee: mvufoŋ
Mosquito: bombo
Cockroach: fífi?, fífy?
Spider: abobo
Spiderweb: ndal-bobo
Scorpion: kádá olədə

12. Fish and Aquatic Animals

Fish: koè, koa, koas, kos
Catfish: eyindá
Herring: efaaga
Cod: mekanda
Sardine: sadina
Whale: ekokoe, zòg maŋ
Shrimp: ngos
Lobster: ndzanga
Crab: kádá, (kárá)

13. Fruits

Fruit: ebumá
Fruits: bibumá
Plum: sa
Black cherries: bivouvoula
Raspberry: mvud
Hazelnut: kome
Kola nut: kola, góro, âbel
Palm nuts: bitôn
Peanuts, groundnuts: owondo
Orange: ofumbi
Lemon: ofumbi beti, (ofumbi biti)
Lime: nyos
Limes: minyos
Pineapple: zæg, [zæk]
Sweet banana: adzoué, (odzoué)
Plantain: akon, ekon
Plantains: bikon

Mango: mangolo
Mango tree: andòg, [andòk]
Guava: afel
Papaya: fofó(lo)
Soursop: ebom, sabosabo
Avocado: fía

14. Vegetables and Crops

Vegetables: ndole
Onion: ayang
Mushroom: hiá, (viá)
Salad, lettuce: salade
Pumpkin: abog
Squash: ngon
Okra: etetám
Okras: betetám
Beans: kón
Chickpeas: nyáda
Maize: fón
Rice: ol?s
Yam: ekodo
Yams: bikodo
Cassava leaves: kpem
Cassava stick: ebobolo
Tapioca: ngali
Macabo: ákaba
Macabos: məkaba
Macabo plant: tín ákaba
Macabo shoot: edzoa ákaba
Macabo leaf: akyé ákaba
Young edible macabo leaf: lombo
Potatoes: metoda

15. Food and Meals

Food, meal: bidí, bidi
Meat: tsíd, [tsít]
Soup, broth, sauce: mfián, mfyán, sub, [sup]

Sauce: (a)nfian, (e)nfian
Okra soup: nfian betetám
Chicken sauce: anfian kúb
Grilled fish: koas amboumen
Pounded plantain: antouba, (entouba)
Couscous: vuvú
Flour: fig, [fik]
Bread: mbanla
Cassava cake: nkonda
Sugar cane: nko?g, [nko?k]
Sugar: minko?g, [minko?k]
Honey: we
Salt: nku
Oil: mbon
Butter: bodo
To eat: á dí
Hunger: zié

16. Drinks

Thirst: ekode
Drink, beverage: menyu
To drink: á nyu
Water: mändím, (mendjip)
Spirits, liquor: bilam
Beer: bia
Maize beer: kpata
Palm wine: meyog
Wine: waïn, mandzunga
Tea: ti
Coffee: kofí
Coffee with milk: kofí aï mányán
Milk: mányán, (milik)
Fermented drink: meyòg

17. Kitchen and Tableware

Tablecloth: napaca
Cooking pot: mvié
Frying pan: fulafan

Plate: esoa
Plates: bisoa
Spoon: tok
Spoons: betok
Teaspoon: man elum
Fork: elum, ilum
Forks: bilum
Knife: oken
Kitchen knife: oken kesin
Bottle: nlombi
Water bottle: nlombi mändím
Wine bottle: nlombi waïn
Glass: el?
Glasses: bel?
Cup: kòb, tás
Coffee cup: kòb kòfi, tás kòfi
Pot: ndæg
Tin can: angóngá
Oil container: angóngá mbon

18. Body Parts

Body: nyúl
Skin: ekob
Hair, body hair: esil
Hairs: bisil
White hair: nyuk
Head: nló
Heads: minló
Forehead: asú
Skull: ekokogolo
Brain: boó
Face: asu
Ear: alò
Ears: mələ
Eyebrows: bivulá
Eyelashes: bivulá
Eyelid: eyé dís
Eyelids: biyé mís

Eye: díś
Eyes: mís
Nose: dzóé
Nostrils: mimbóg mí dzóé
Moustache: abub
Cheek: amán
Cheeks: məmán
Lip: eyé anyu
Mouth: anyu
Tongue: oyəm, nquoba
Tooth: ason
Teeth: məson
Chin: eyəgəs
Beard: zəl
Neck: kíñ
Back of the neck: döl
Throat: enğon
Chest: nkug, [nkuk]
Hip: ənğədəğ
Navel: døb, [döp]
Belly, abdomen: abum
Liver: esəğ, [esək]
Stomach: osan
Intestine: nya, nyè
Intestines: minyè
Kidney: otám
Urinary bladder: enyolòğ
Lung: esâga
Heart: nnəm
Hearts: minnəm
Blood: meki
Artery, vein: nsis
Nerve: nsis
Back: mvús
Shoulder: etúl, ebog
Shoulders: bitúl
Arm: enam
Arms: binam

Armpit: mvan
Elbow: ekúd bøn
Wrist: onğás
Hand: wọ
Hands: mọ
Palm: dóé
Thumb: mod onyu
Finger: onyu
Fingers: mənyu
Nail: dzyé, dzíé
Nails: byé, bíé, mbyé
Buttock: akan
Buttocks: məkan
Leg, foot: akol
Legs, feet: məkol
Knee: abøn
Calf: mbyán
Ankle: mvonğolọ
Heel: ekíndi
Sole of the foot: tín akol
Toe: onyu akol
Toes: mənyu məkol

19. Health and Medical Care

Life: ənyin
Living people: bənyin
Healthy, in good health: mvové
Illness, disease: ankokoan
Sick, ill: a kọn
Sick person: ankokon
Sick people: minkokon
Cough: ekoe
Fever: fiba, (ndurhu)
Ambulance: pimpan
Hospital, clinic, dispensary: dobdo, wadfida
Doctor, physician: doabra, dokta
Dentist: doabra meson

Medicines: mebala
To breathe: həbə, (vəbə)
To urinate: vyé
Soul, spirit, thought: nsisim
Spirits: minsisim
Dreams: bihiyem

20. Clothing and Materials

Hat: ntóm
Scarf, bandana: yangis
Handkerchief: nabken, [napken]
Coat, jacket: koʔd, [koʔt]
Raincoat: lʔn koʔd, [lʔn koʔt]
Shirt: sòt
Leather belt: kanda
Skirt, dress: kaba
Sock: zitogan, (zitoken)
Shoes: ngob, [ngop]
Sandals, slippers: sili fas
Walking stick: wagstik, ntum
Bag: mfəg, [mfək]
Bags: mimfəg, [mimfək], minkud, [minkut]
Wallet, purse: posi
Basket: minkwé
Tailor, dressmaker: təla
To sew, join: lad
Silk: silig, [silik]
Cotton: sud, [sut]
Velvet: velves
Rubber: ndamba

21. Family

Family: ndá bod, (ndábod)
Head of the family: nló ndá bod, (nló ndábod)
Ancestor: mvám
Ancestors: bimvám, (bətadá)
Grandparent: emvám

Grandparents: bimvám
Grandfather: emvám fám
Grandmother: emvám miníngá
Parents: bebonde
Father: esia, esya, pəpá
Fathers: beesia
Mother: nyiá, mama
Mothers: be nyiá
Man: fám
Woman: miníngá
Women: biníngá
Adult woman: nyia miníngá
Adult man: nyamodo
Husband: nnóm
Wife: ngál
Single people: minkoe
Uncles: benyiandomo
Aunt: esenga
Nephew, niece: man kál
Brother: manyan, ndóm
Sister: manyan, kál
Child: mọngo
Children: bọngo, bon
Little child: man mọngo
Boy: man fám
Girl: man miníngá
Son: ndómán
Daughter: ngon
Baby, infant: mon

22. People and Relationships

Person: mòd, [mòt]
People: bòd, [bòt]
Friend: mvoe
Friends: bemvove
Dear friend: mbos edin
Enemy: nziziŋ, (nzinziŋ)
Guest: eyem

Guests: beyem, bihenk
Old: nnom
Old man: nnom mod
Elderly people: minnom mi bod
Elder: mvindi mod
Righteous, just: soso
Good person: soso mod

23. House and Construction

House: ndá
Houses: mendá
Garden: ngadan
Fence: fen
Wooden plank: abám
Carpenter: kabinda
Bricklayer, mason: mawad
Brick: brik
Cement: simen
Wall: mfim
Walls: mimfim
Window: wúndi
Door: mb?
Key: edibəga, (edibiga)
Keys: bidibəga, (bidibiga)
Hallway, corridor: nlan
Room: abaa, etun nda
Living room: abaa, zan daa
Bedroom: etun ndá, etun a bombò
Kitchen: kasiŋ, (kesiŋ)
Electricity: elektrik

24. Furniture and Household Objects

Picture, painting: tablo
Photograph: foda
Television: television
Radio: radio
Bed: enòn
Beds: binòn

Bedcover, blanket: mfingá, (mfiŋá)
Pillow: fila
Cushion: abaaga, (aba'a)
Candle: kiendre
Lamp: alamba
Lamps: melamba
Wardrobe, cupboard: kobod, [kobot],
quoibra
Shelf: mintánán
Shelves: bitánán
Table: tebele
Bench: ban
Chair, seat: etoa, (sia)
Chairs, seats: bitoa
Bath towel: tawola
Soap: sọbọ, sabula
Comb: faag
Perfume: alobinda
Bucket: nlongá
Machine: nsina
Washing machine: nsina osòb
Iron: hayan
Objects: biem

25. City and Public Places

City, town: dzaI, edzedzala, n'gola, ongola
Cities, towns: mal
Village: dzaI
Mayor, village chief: mod dzaI
Tribal chief: ehedeman
Hotel: watele
Café, bar: kofí
Restaurant: ndá bidí, nda bidi
Canteen: kantin
School: sikúlu, (sukúlu)
Cinema: sinema
Shop, store: efatsila
Market: makid, [makit], mekid, [mekit]

Office building: wafis
Desk: buro
Bank, banker: ban
Police: fulús
Gendarmerie: gendarmeri
Prison: mimbog, [mimbok]

26. School and Work

Pupil: mọngo sikúlu
Student: nyege sikúlu
Teacher, professor: eyegele
Book: ka?lada, (ka?lara)
Books: bəka?lada, (bəka?lara)
Notebook: kaye
Secretary: nsan bəkalara
Cook: kugu
Seller: nkuan
Buyer: nkus
To sell: a kuan
To buy: a kwi
To sign: asan
Cheque: chek
Money: m̀oni
Police officer: mane bezimbi
Police officers: bezimbi
Police commissioner: komsafulus
Thief, burglar: nwúwúb
Prisoner: mbog, [mbok]
Captive: nkom

27. Travel and Transport

Journey, trip: dulu
Journeys, trips: mulu
To travel: awulu
Suitcase: valis
Boat: zitima
Train: nsina-minkòn
Train station: gare, banhog

Ticket: tiket
Road, path: zen
Roads, paths: mezen
Bus, coach: bus, otobus, otokar
Bus stop: etye bus
Car: mətua
Cars: bə mətua
Vehicle: mətua
Garage: nda mətua
Petrol, gasoline: benzin
Engine: mətua, engin
Helmet: helmed, [helmet]
Motorcycle, moped: otòm
Bicycle: nka nganda, basko

28. Sports and Activities

Dance, to dance: adzem
Funeral dance: esani
Wrestling: mesin
To walk: wulu
To run: á wulu mbil
Yard, playground: nsən
Sports stadium: nsən ndamba, stade
Ball: ndamba, ebumá
Football: futbal, ndamba
Football match: bivoe bi ndamba
Team: ngam
Referee: nlan mengoe
Champion: zingi
To fish, fishing: alog, [alok], nlòb
Fishermen: belob
To hunt, hunting: nsom
Trap: olám, (oláma)
Deadfall trap: ekudi
Snare trap: minkumu
To play: voe
Playing card: kart dzia

Game, games: bivoë
Types of games: nkane bivoë

29. Colours

Black: ehindi
White: mfum
Red: m'avié
Pale-coloured: abomdzam
To become black, darken: a vin

30. Essential Verbs

To answer: yalan
To ask: sili
To breathe: həbə, (vəbə)
To buy: a kwi
To catch: bi
To cry: ayon, (səm)
To dance: adzem
To drink: á nyu
To dry: kód
To eat: á dí
To fish: alog, [alok], nlòb
To hear, listen, understand: a wóg, [a wók]
To hunt: nsom
To invite: abanda
To lie down: bómbo
To look at: bəbə
To play: voe
To rain: a noan
To read: aa lan
To run: á wulu mbil
To sell: a kuan
To sew: lad
To sign: asan
To sit down: tɔbɔ
To sweep: vwé
To travel: awulu
To urinate: vyé

To walk: wulu
To wash: sob
To wipe: a fim mi
To wear: beege